

PART 1 — CLIENT-FACING PRE-MEETING INTAKE (HIGH-LEVEL)

Purpose: Let the client “talk high-level” so you can qualify whether the project is worth your time. Tone: Simple, non-technical, approachable. Goal: Capture symptoms, not root causes.

SECTION A — Basic Company Context

1. What does your company manufacture? 2. How many plants or production lines do you operate? 3. What is your typical daily/weekly output? 4. What percentage of your orders are on-time vs late?

SECTION B — What You Believe the Problem Is

(This is intentionally vague — you want their “story,” not the truth.)

5. In your own words, what problem are you experiencing? 6. When did this issue first begin? 7. What has changed recently (equipment, people, suppliers, demand)? 8. What do you believe is causing the issue? 9. What have you already tried to fix it?

SECTION C — Impact & Urgency

10. How is this issue impacting production? 11. How is it impacting cost, quality, or delivery? 12. What happens if nothing changes in the next 30–90 days? 13. How urgent is this project for you? (Low / Medium / High)

SECTION D — Decision & Engagement Fit

14. Who will be involved in the decision to hire a consultant? 15. What is your ideal timeline for engagement? 16. What budget range have you allocated? 17. What does success look like for you?

PART 2 — DEEP-DIVE DISCOVERY DOCUMENT (LIVE MEETING)

Purpose: Uncover the **real root cause**, not the client’s narrative. Tone: Professional, technical, probing. Goal: Identify hidden constraints, variation sources, and systemic failures.

SECTION A — Production Flow & Bottlenecks

1. Walk me through your production flow from raw material to finished goods. 2. Where does WIP accumulate? 3. What is your takt time vs actual cycle time? 4. How do you currently identify bottlenecks? 5. Have bottlenecks shifted recently?

SECTION B — Equipment, Downtime & Maintenance

6. What are your top 5 downtime drivers? 7. Do you track MTBF / MTTR? 8. What percentage of maintenance is reactive vs preventive? 9. What failure modes repeat? 10. How is tooling wear monitored?

SECTION C — Quality & Variation

11. What defects occur most frequently? 12. Do you use SPC? What processes are charted? 13. Have you performed Gage R&R on critical measurements? 14. How stable are raw material inputs? 15. What environmental factors influence quality?

SECTION D — Scheduling, Inventory & Flow Control

16. Do you operate push or pull scheduling? 17. How do you size Kanban loops? 18. What is your average WIP level vs ideal? 19. How often do you experience stockouts or overstock? 20. How do you level production (heijunka)?

SECTION E — People, Training & Standard Work

21. Are work instructions standardized and followed? 22. How much tribal knowledge exists? 23. What is the skill distribution across operators? 24. Where do operators deviate from standard work? 25. What training gaps exist?

SECTION F — Controls, Sensors & Automation

26. What PLC/DCS/SCADA systems are in place? 27. What alarms repeat or get ignored? 28. How often are sensors calibrated? 29. What intermittent faults occur? 30. What logic changes have been made recently?

SECTION G — Hidden Root Cause Identification

31. What problem do you believe you have? 32. What problem do the numbers suggest you have? 33. What problem do operators believe you have? 34. What problem does the flow actually reveal? 35. What problem does the constraint analysis reveal?